

The Folio Society Edition of Riddley Walker

Cite as: Martin Paul Eve, "The Folio Society Edition of Riddley Walker", *eve.gd: Martin Paul Eve*, April 21, 2017, <https://doi.org/10.59348/yxb99-4nk57>.

Cheap it is not, but the [Folio Society Edition of Russell Hoban's *Riddley Walker*](#) is a beautiful item to behold.

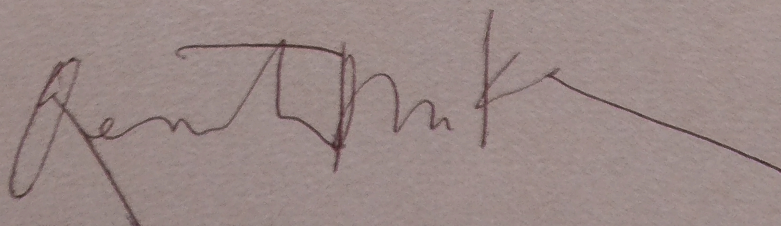


The edition itself is limited to a run of 1,000 copies signed by the illustrator, Quentin Blake, and ours is #15.

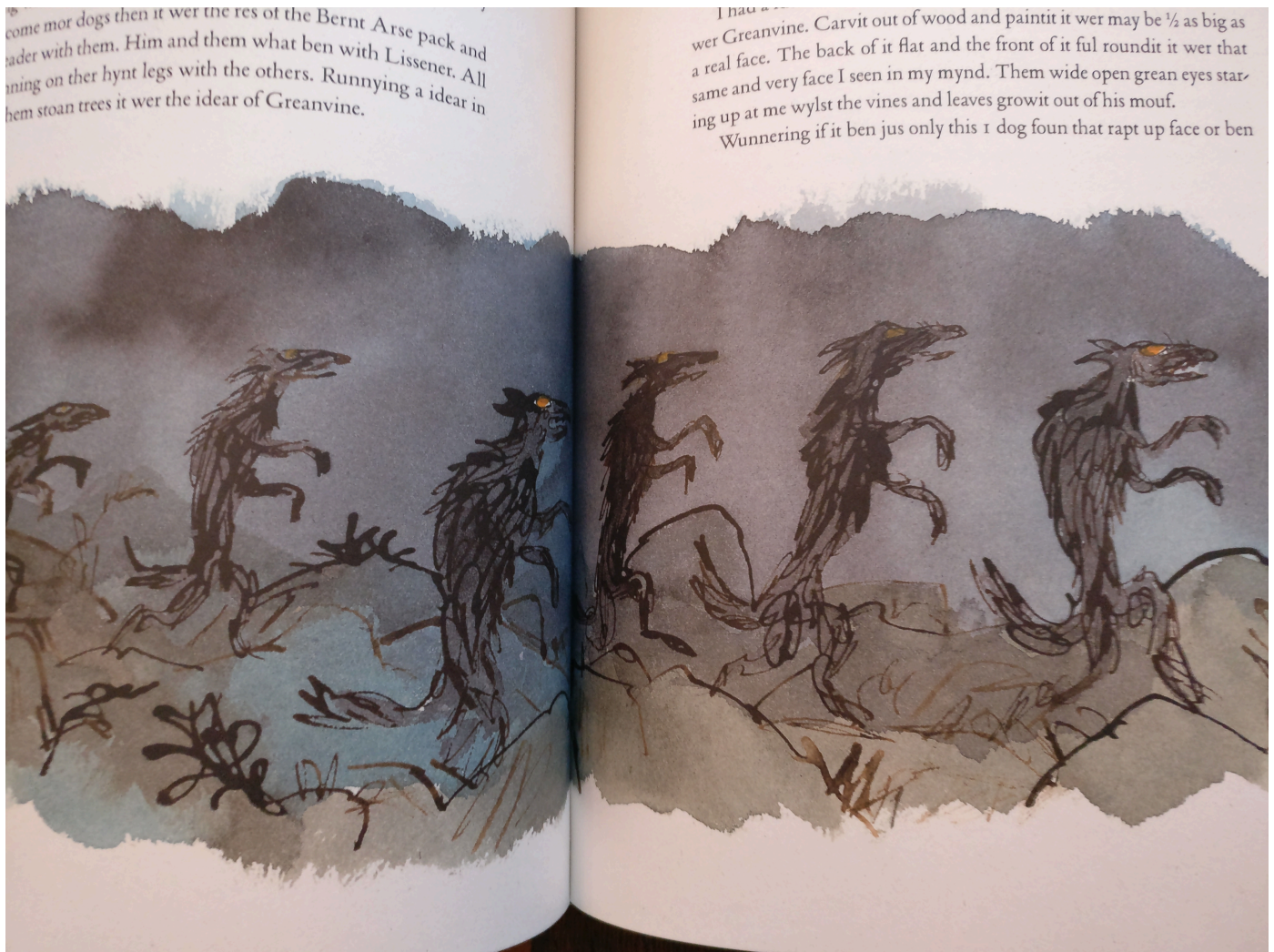
THIS EDITION OF *RIDDLEY WALKER*
HAS BEEN TYPESET IN POLIPHILUS AND
BLADO TYPES AT THE FOLIO SOCIETY. THE
ILLUSTRATIONS HAVE BEEN REPRODUCED BY
TAG INTERNATIONAL. IT HAS BEEN PRINTED BY
KÖSEL, KRUGZELL, GERMANY, ON WOODSTOCK
BETULLA PAPER AND BOUND BY THEM IN DUCH-
ESSE OFFSET CLOTH PRINTED WITH A DESIGN
BY QUENTIN BLAKE. IT IS LIMITED TO 1000
COPIES, SIGNED AND NUMBERED BY THE
ARTIST, AND 20 LETTERED COPIES
WHICH ARE NOT FOR SALE.

THIS IS COPY NUMBER

15

A handwritten signature in dark ink, which appears to be "Quentin Blake", written in a cursive, flowing style.

The illustrations themselves are wonderful. The dogs, in particular, are stunning (and, of course, key to the novel itself.)



The book also contains an afterword by Rowan Williams – an “Ardship of Cambry” himself, as the novel might have it – which contains the excellent line: “If all good fiction has the effect of making us strange in our own eyes and ears, Hoban’s books are very good fiction indeed; and *Riddley Walker* holds a unique place simply because it is the most systematic in both imagining and enacting the alchemical transmutations of speech in the wake of unimaginable cultural trauma.”



The notes from Quentin Blake are also excellent here and it is great that he used quill pens, in the age of technological printing, to make the drawings. Some credit should definitely also go to Jake Wilson (surely the “mutual friend” to whom Quentin refers), whom I know has worked silently and uncredited behind the scenes on various parts of this project.

